MERROWFIELD DIGITAL

Playbook: Lost or stolen device

Document Playbook 05 | Rev 3 | Effective 9 February 2026 | Owner: Security Operations | Review cycle: 12 months

1. What this playbook covers

This playbook covers laptops, phones and tablets that are lost or stolen, with or without Merrowfield data on them. It is used by the Security Analyst who investigates, from the first alert until the incident is closed.

2. How it is usually recognised

- an employee reporting a missing or stolen device
- a device that stops checking in with device management

3. The first hour

1. Send a remote lock and wipe.
2. Revoke the device's sessions and certificates, and reset the user's password.
3. Confirm from device management whether the disk was encrypted, and whether the recovery key was held centrally or with the device.
4. For a theft, record the police report number on the incident.

4. Evidence to preserve

- device management records: encryption status and last check-in
- the employee's account of when and where the device was lost
- the list of data stored on the device or synchronised to it

5. Establishing the facts a report needs

Whatever is decided, the decision needs these facts, established as early as they can be:

- what data was on the device, and whose
- whether the disk was encrypted with a key that was not compromised - the state recorded as Encrypted
- whether the PIN or password was kept with the device
- how many customers are affected, in the EU and in India

6. Reporting

Which reporting procedures apply is settled from the incident's facts by the rules in Plan 01, section 8, and each procedure's deadlines are read from that procedure. This playbook sets no deadline of its own, and the decision belongs to the Data Protection Officer.

Whether the device was Encrypted with its key intact decides whether customers need be told under Procedure 01, and usually the harm band too.

7. What affected customers should do

When customers are told, the notice gives them these steps, in this order:

- Where the device was encrypted, you do not need to do anything: the data cannot be read.
- Where it was not, be alert to unexpected contact that uses your details. We will tell you if there is anything you need to do.

8. Closing the incident

Issue a replacement with encryption verified, update the asset register, and remind the team how to carry devices when travelling.